

OFFICIAL LANGUAGE

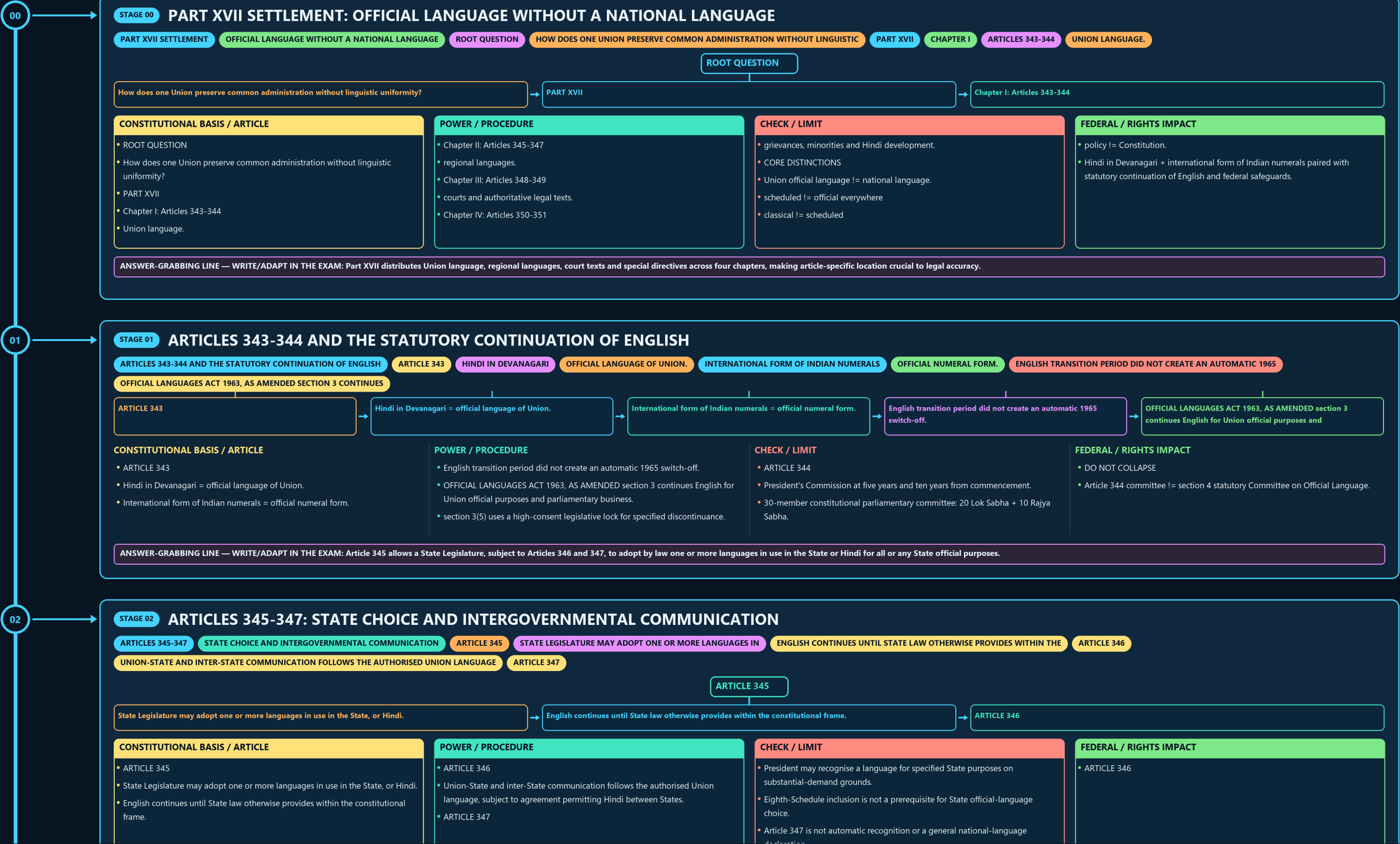
PART XVII SETTLEMENT: OFFICIAL → ARTICLES 343-344 AND THE → ARTICLES 345-347: STATE CHOICE → ARTICLES 348-349: COURTS, JUDGMENTS → ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B → EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 repaired in place for answer-line and visual-boundary quality • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



02

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 345 allows a State Legislature, subject to Articles 346 and 347, to adopt by law one or more languages in use in the State or Hindi for all or any State official purposes.

STAGE 02ARTICLES 345-347: STATE CHOICE AND INTERGOVERNMENTAL COMMUNICATION

ARTICLES 345-347STATE CHOICE AND INTERGOVERNMENTAL COMMUNICATIONARTICLE 345STATE LEGISLATURE MAY ADOPT ONE OR MORE LANGUAGES INENGLISH CONTINUES UNTIL STATE LAW OTHERWISE PROVIDES WITHIN THEARTICLE 346UNION-STATE AND INTER-STATE COMMUNICATION FOLLOWS THE AUTHORISED UNION LANGUAGEARTICLE 347

ARTICLE 345

State Legislature may adopt one or more languages in use in the State, or Hindi.English continues until State law otherwise provides within the constitutional frame.ARTICLE 346

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

ARTICLE 345State Legislature may adopt one or more languages in use in the State, or Hindi.English continues until State law otherwise provides within the constitutional frame.

POWER / PROCEDURE

ARTICLE 346Union-State and inter-State communication follows the authorised Union language, subject to agreement permitting Hindi between States.ARTICLE 347

CHECK / LIMIT

President may recognise a language for specified State purposes on substantial-demand grounds.Eighth-Schedule inclusion is not a prerequisite for State official-language choice.Article 347 is not automatic recognition or a general national-language declaration.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

ARTICLE 346

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Linguistic-minority protection extends beyond the Eighth Schedule, preventing scheduled-language status from becoming the sole measure of constitutional access.

03

STAGE 03ARTICLES 348-349: COURTS, JUDGMENTS AND AUTHORITATIVE TEXTS

ARTICLES 348-349COURTS, JUDGMENTS AND AUTHORITATIVE TEXTSARTICLE 348 BASELINEENGLISH FOR SUPREME COURT AND HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGS UNTILENGLISH AUTHORITATIVE TEXTS FOR BILLS, ACTS, ORDINANCES, ORDERS, RULESHIGH COURT PROCEEDINGSGOVERNOR + PREVIOUS PRESIDENTIAL CONSENTHINDI OR STATE OFFICIAL LANGUAGE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

ARTICLE 348 BASELINEEnglish for Supreme Court and High Court proceedings until Parliament provides otherwise.English authoritative texts for Bills, Acts, ordinances, orders, rules and bye-laws.

POWER / PROCEDURE

HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGSGovernor + previous presidential consent → Hindi or State official language.Article 348(2) expressly excludes judgments, decrees and orders.

CHECK / LIMIT

SECTION 7 ROUTE authorised non-English High Court judgment/decreed/order in addition to EnglishHigh Court-authorised English translation.ARTICLE 349 historically time-bounded special procedure; not a routine present-day gate.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

LIMIT machine or general-information translation is not automatically authoritative law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 348 retains English for Supreme Court and High Court proceedings, preserving national legal continuity despite multilingual administration.

04

STAGE 04ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B AND 351: ACCESS AND DEVELOPMENT

ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B AND 351ACCESS AND DEVELOPMENTARTICLE 350 REPRESENTATION FOR GRIEVANCE REDRESS MAY USE AARTICLE 350A ENDEAVOUR TO PROVIDE MOTHER-TONGUE INSTRUCTION FACILITIES ATARTICLE 350BSPECIAL OFFICER INVESTIGATES SAFEGUARDSREPORTS TO PRESIDENTLAID BEFORE PARLIAMENT AND SENT TO CONCERNED STATE GOVERNMENTS.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

ARTICLE 350 representation for grievance redress may use a language used in the Union or State.ARTICLE 350A endeavour to provide mother-tongue instruction facilities at primary stage for children belonging to linguistic-minority groups.ARTICLE 350B

POWER / PROCEDURE

Special Officer investigates safeguards → reports to Presidentlaid before Parliament and sent to concerned State governments.ARTICLE 351

CHECK / LIMIT

Union duty to promote Hindi and develop it as a medium for India's composite culture, drawing vocabulary principallyfrom Sanskrit and secondarily from other languages.BALANCE promotion of Hindi operates with, not above, plural safeguards and federal consent.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Special Officer investigates safeguards → reports to President

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 351 promotes Hindi as a medium for India's composite culture, so development of one language cannot be separated from linguistic pluralism.

05

STAGE 05EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS AND THE THREE-LANGUAGE POLICY BOUNDARY

EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS AND THE THREE-LANGUAGE POLICY BOUNDARYEIGHTH SCHEDULE22 LANGUAGES IN THE CURRENT OFFICIAL CONSTITUTION.14 ORIGINALORIYA RENAMED ODIA.EFFECT CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION AND ARTICLE 344/351 RELEVANCE.NO AUTOMATIC UNION, STATE, COURT OR SCHOOL-MEDIUM STATUS FOLLOWS.CLASSICAL STATUS SEPARATE UNION EXECUTIVE RECOGNITION.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

POWER / PROCEDURE

CHECK / LIMIT

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

OFFICIAL LANGUAGE • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2170-5404 of 9745 • continues below

04

STAGE 04

ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B AND 351: ACCESS AND DEVELOPMENT

ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B AND 351

ACCESS AND DEVELOPMENT

ARTICLE 350 REPRESENTATION FOR GRIEVANCE REDRESS MAY USE A

ARTICLE 350A ENDEAVOUR TO PROVIDE MOTHER-TONGUE INSTRUCTION FACILITIES AT

ARTICLE 350B

SPECIAL OFFICER INVESTIGATES SAFEGUARDS

REPORTS TO PRESIDENT

LAID BEFORE PARLIAMENT AND SENT TO CONCERNED STATE GOVERNMENTS.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 350 representation for grievance redress may use a language used in the Union or State.
- ARTICLE 350A endeavour to provide mother-tongue instruction facilities at primary stage for children belonging to linguistic-minority groups.
- ARTICLE 350B

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Special Officer investigates safeguards → reports to President
- laid before Parliament and sent to concerned State governments.
- ARTICLE 351

CHECK / LIMIT

- Union duty to promote Hindi and develop it as a medium for India's composite culture, drawing vocabulary principally
- from Sanskrit and secondarily from other languages.
- BALANCE promotion of Hindi operates with, not above, plural safeguards and federal consent.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Special Officer investigates safeguards → reports to President

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 351 promotes Hindi as a medium for India's composite culture, so development of one language cannot be separated from linguistic pluralism.

05

STAGE 05

EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS AND THE THREE-LANGUAGE POLICY BOUNDARY

EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS AND THE THREE-LANGUAGE POLICY BOUNDARY

EIGHTH SCHEDULE

22 LANGUAGES IN THE CURRENT OFFICIAL CONSTITUTION.

14 ORIGINAL

ORIYA RENAMED ODIA.

EFFECT CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION AND ARTICLE 344/351 RELEVANCE.

NO AUTOMATIC UNION, STATE, COURT OR SCHOOL-MEDIUM STATUS FOLLOWS.

CLASSICAL STATUS SEPARATE UNION EXECUTIVE RECOGNITION.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
EIGHTH SCHEDULE	Oriya renamed Odia.	CLASSICAL STATUS separate Union executive recognition.	It is not a constitutional national-language command.
22 languages in the current official Constitution.	EFFECT constitutional recognition and Article 344/351 relevance.	October 2024 additions brought the official count then reported to eleven.	
14 original → Sindhi → Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali → Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhali	No automatic Union, State, court or school-medium status follows.	THREE-LANGUAGE FORMULA education-policy framework with State implementation variation.	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- EIGHTH SCHEDULE
- 22 languages in the current official Constitution.
- 14 original → Sindhi → Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali → Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhali

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Oriya renamed Odia.
- EFFECT constitutional recognition and Article 344/351 relevance.
- No automatic Union, State, court or school-medium status follows.

CHECK / LIMIT

- CLASSICAL STATUS separate Union executive recognition.
- October 2024 additions brought the official count then reported to eleven.
- THREE-LANGUAGE FORMULA education-policy framework with State implementation variation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- It is not a constitutional national-language command.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Scheduled status also carries substantial public-policy and symbolic importance, but it does not make every listed language an “official language of India” for all administrative or judicial purposes.

06

STAGE 06

LANGUAGE CASES: COMPETENCE, MINORITY CONTEXT AND PROTECTED CHOICE

LANGUAGE CASES

COMPETENCE, MINORITY CONTEXT AND PROTECTED CHOICE

GUJARAT UNIVERSITY V. SHRI KRISHNA (1963) MEDIUM/LANGUAGE POWER MUST

D.A.V. COLLEGE V. STATE OF PUNJAB (1971) LINGUISTIC-MINORITY SAFEGUARDS

STATE OF KARNATAKA V. ASSOCIATED MANAGEMENT (2014) COMPULSORY MOTHER-TONGUE

DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE LEGISLATIVE COMPETENCE

SPEECH/CHOICE RIGHTS

LINGUISTIC-MINORITY SAFEGUARDS.

Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.

D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971) linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis.

State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014) compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice.

DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE legislative competence

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.
- D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971) linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014) compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice.
- DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE legislative competence

CHECK / LIMIT

- speech/choice rights
- linguistic-minority safeguards.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- LIMIT none of these decisions declares a national language or erases Article 350A.
- Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Listing does not automatically make a language the Union language, a State language, a court language, a school medium or a classical language.

07

STAGE 07

FEDERAL ACCOMMODATION, COURT ACCESS AND TRANSLATION TECHNOLOGY

FEDERAL ACCOMMODATION, COURT ACCESS AND TRANSLATION TECHNOLOGY

LEGITIMATE GOALS ADMINISTRATIVE INTEROPERABILITY

CITIZEN ACCESS

CULTURAL RECOGNITION JUDICIAL USABILITY

EDUCATIONAL INCLUSION.

RISKS IMPOSITION

EXCLUSION FROM EMPLOYMENT/SERVICES

TRANSLATION ERROR AUTHORITATIVE-TEXT CONFUSION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- LEGITIMATE GOALS administrative interoperability

POWER / PROCEDURE

- RISKS imposition

CHECK / LIMIT

- digital language divide.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- LIMIT policy targets, committee recommendations and software outputs do not

OFFICIAL LANGUAGE • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 4341-7575 of 9745 • continues below

D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971) linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis.

State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014) compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice.

DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE legislative competence

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.
- D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971) linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014) compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice.
- DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE legislative competence

CHECK / LIMIT

- speech/choice rights
- linguistic-minority safeguards.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- LIMIT none of these decisions declares a national language or erases Article 350A.
- Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Listing does not automatically make a language the Union language, a State language, a court language, a school medium or a classical language.

07

STAGE 07

FEDERAL ACCOMMODATION, COURT ACCESS AND TRANSLATION TECHNOLOGY

FEDERAL ACCOMMODATION, COURT ACCESS AND TRANSLATION TECHNOLOGY

LEGITIMATE GOALS ADMINISTRATIVE INTEROPERABILITY

CITIZEN ACCESS

CULTURAL RECOGNITION JUDICIAL USABILITY

EDUCATIONAL INCLUSION.

RISKS IMPOSITION

EXCLUSION FROM EMPLOYMENT/SERVICES

TRANSLATION ERROR AUTHORITATIVE-TEXT CONFUSION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- LEGITIMATE GOALS administrative interoperability
- citizen access
- cultural recognition judicial usability
- educational inclusion.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- RISKS imposition
- exclusion from employment/services
- translation error authoritative-text confusion
- weak minority facilities

CHECK / LIMIT

- digital language divide.
- TECHNOLOGY CHAIN multilingual intake → translation/interpretation → human legal review
- authority label → version control → accessible publication.
- FEDERAL METHOD consent + capacity + phased implementation + reciprocal communication.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- LIMIT policy targets, committee recommendations and software outputs do not amend Part XVII.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: English in higher courts supports a common precedential and inter-State legal medium, but it can distance litigants and many lawyers from the language of adjudication.

08

STAGE 08

UPSC TRAPS, VERIFIED PYQ AND QUALIFIED ANSWER SYNTHESIS

UPSC TRAPS, VERIFIED PYQ AND QUALIFIED ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PRELIMS FIREWALL OFFICIAL

22 SCHEDULED LANGUAGES

HINDI SCRIPT

DEVANAGARI NUMERALS

INTERNATIONAL FORM

ENGLISH CONTINUATION

ARTICLE 348(2) EXCLUDES JUDGMENTS

PRELIMS FIREWALL official != national

22 scheduled languages

Hindi script = Devanagari numerals = international form

English continuation = statute

Article 348(2) excludes judgments

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PRELIMS FIREWALL official != national
- 22 scheduled languages
- Hindi script = Devanagari numerals = international form
- English continuation = statute

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Article 348(2) excludes judgments
- section 7 supplies separate route
- Article 350 grievance right
- 350A instruction facility

CHECK / LIMIT

- 350B Special Officer classical and three-language categories are separate.
- 2024 PRELIMS ROUTE
- 21st, 71st and 92nd Amendment language additions.
- MAINS SPINE constitutional compromise → Part XVII → 1963 Act

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- State autonomy → court/text hierarchy → minority safeguards
- category distinctions → access technology → federal verdict.
- CONCLUSION multilingual unity requires exact law, consent and authoritative parity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — category distinctions → access technology → federal verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Classical status does not itself alter Part XVII, the Eighth Schedule, State official-language law or Article 348.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (ARTS 343–344)

PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (ARTS 345–347)

PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (ARTS

PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (ARTS 350–351)

PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE

ART 343

HINDI IN DEVANAGARI SCRIPT

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344)
- PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (Arts 345–347)
- PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (Arts 348–349)
- PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (Arts 350–351)

ADVANCED LIMIT

- PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE
- Art 343: Hindi in Devanagari script = official language of the Union ; numerals = international
- English to continue for 15 years (1950–1965) ; Parliament may extend its use beyond that.
- Language Commissions (5th & 10th year): first under B.G. Kher (1955) ; examined by a parliamentary

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Official Languages Act, 1963 — allows English indefinitely (no time limit) alongside Hindi;
- Constitution does not specify states' official languages — a state legislature may adopt any language(s)
- A state's choice is NOT limited to the Eighth Schedule (e.g., states have adopted non-8th-Schedule tongues).
- Art 347: On demand, if a substantial population wants it, the President may direct official recognition of

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.